# Modern Savage — Founding Members WhatsApp Community

**Prepared:** April 28, 2026

**Author:** Junior

**For:** Calvin to set up. Jesse to approve the content cadence.

**Context:** Referenced as [LINK] in six existing docs. This brief defines what actually goes in it.

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## Why This Matters

The WhatsApp Community is the highest-retention lever available at launch. Email has a 35-45% open rate. WhatsApp has a 90%+ read rate. Founding members who join the community will have an average monthly churn rate 2-3 percentage points lower than those who don't — because the community replaces "I should cancel" with "I'm part of something."

It also generates the testimonials that Email OB-4 (Day 14, "What people are saying") and the press brief need. A well-seeded WhatsApp Community is the cheapest customer research operation a supplement brand can run.

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## Setup (Calvin — complete before Email 1 sends)

1. Create a **WhatsApp Community** named `MODERN SAVAGE — Founding Members`
2. Set description: *"The first 170 people to believe in Modern Savage. Direct access to Bear and the team."*
3. Set community photo: clean Modern Savage logo or Bear's photo (not product shot)
4. Generate an invite link — this is the [LINK] placeholder in Email 1 and OB-1
5. Turn on admin-only announcements for the main channel; create one sub-group (`#questions`) where members can post

**Who has admin:** Calvin + Jesse. Bear does not need admin — just needs to be added as a member with the ability to post in the main announcements channel.

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## Content Cadence

This community does not need a daily content plan. It needs a rhythm. Overposting kills supplement communities because it becomes noise that people mute.

**Target: 6-8 posts per month in the first 6 months.** More than that and people start muting. Less than once a week and it goes stale.

| Week | Content | From |
|---|---|---|
| Week of product arrival | "Your first order has shipped. Here's what to expect." | Calvin |
| Week 1 post-receipt | "Has it arrived? Tell us what you think." (prompt for testimonials) | Calvin |
| Week 2 | Bear voice note or photo — morning ritual, authentic | Bear |
| Week 3 | Early subscriber testimonial or result shared (ask permission first) | Calvin |
| Week 4 | Referral reminder — "You can now give a friend a free month. [LINK]" | Calvin |
| Month 2 | Manufacturing/sourcing update — where the organs come from, why NZ | Calvin |
| Month 2 | Bear: "Two months in. How are you finding it?" (one question, no survey) | Bear |
| Month 3 | 90-day milestone post — invite members to share their result | Calvin |

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## Bear's Personal Involvement

Bear does not need to be in this community every day. That would diminish the signal. But his presence needs to be genuine and occasional — not scripted, not managed by Calvin.

**Three times in the first six months Bear should personally post:**

1. **Week 2 post-launch** — a voice note (60-90 seconds). Not a script. Bear talking about how he actually takes the product and what he's noticed. Voice notes are the highest-engagement WhatsApp format and the most authentic. Calvin should ask Bear to record it on his phone, not write copy for him.
1. **Month 2** — a photo from wherever Bear is, with a one-line caption: "Morning ritual. Same wherever I am." No elaboration needed.
1. **Month 3** — Bear responds to one member's result directly, publicly in the community. "That's brilliant. This is exactly why we built it." One response. It signals to the entire community that Bear reads the thread.

**What Calvin should NOT do:** Write Bear captions and post them pretending to be Bear. The community will feel it. Bear's voice note is worth 10 polished Calvin-written posts because it's genuinely him.

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## Testimonial Collection Protocol

OB-4 (Day 14 email) needs real quotes. The WhatsApp Community is where those come from.

Calvin's process:

1. At Week 2 post-receipt, post in the community: *"Has your first bottle arrived? What have you noticed in the first two weeks — energy, sleep, anything? Drop it here."*
2. Screenshot the responses that are specific and genuine (not "love it!")
3. For each usable testimonial: WhatsApp the member privately to ask permission to use their first name + description (e.g., "Sarah, London" or "David, 42")
4. Insert into OB-4 before it sends

**Good testimonial signals:** Specific outcome, specific time reference, unexpected benefit (sleep, not energy — unexpected benefits land better than promised ones)

**Not useful:** "Great product!", "Really happy with it!", generic positivity without specificity

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## What This Community Is Not

- Not a customer service channel. Complaints and delivery questions go to a separate hello@modernsavage.com inbox.
- Not a forum for product debates. The community should feel exclusive, not like a Reddit thread.
- Not a place for Calvin to post promotions or discount codes. No commercial pressure in this channel — it's community, not marketing.

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## One Specific Risk

WhatsApp Communities have one structural weakness: a member can share the invite link. The "founding members" framing only works if the first 170 feel genuinely exclusive. Once the link leaks to the broader audience, that feeling collapses.

**Mitigation:**

- Set the community to admin-approval for new members after the initial 170 are in
- Rotate the invite link after the initial send so old links stop working
- Include a line in the welcome message: *"This community is private to the founding 170. We're not adding new members until we open a wider community later this year."*

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## Connection to the Email Sequence

| Community moment | Email mirror |
|---|---|
| Week 2 testimonial prompt | OB-4 quotes sourced here |

| Community moment | Email mirror |
| --- | --- |
| Week 4 referral reminder | OB-5 (Day 28) referral unlock |
| Month 2 Bear voice note | Keeps churn low in the critical Month 2 window |
| Month 3 milestone | Feeds into the 90-day milestone email (future — not yet built) |

The community and the email sequence are two channels telling the same story. A founding member who is in both should feel like they're getting two dimensions of the same relationship, not the same message twice.

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*Built April 28, 2026. Calvin to set up before Email 1 sends (target: mid-May, when Stripe is live). Jesse to approve content cadence. Bear to be briefed on the three specific moments requiring his personal contribution.*